Open Door
Judge's Guide

Cultural discovery that starts with what you love—and makes room for the day you actually need.



ONE GUIDE, TWO WAYS IN

01 — Explore for yourself: Solo Discovery, Taste Bridge, What If? Explorer, and Discovery Debate.

02 — Help others explore: a separate group, destination, and occasion-oriented path.

Allow about eight minutes, plus live-request time. Qloo grounds the cultural discoveries.

Why Qloo matters

Open Door does not ask a language model to guess what people like. Qloo Search resolves named cultural interests, and Qloo Insights retrieves connections that ground the live discovery workflow. Returned entities can become anchors for the next exploration.

Try the app: https://open-door.replit.app

Web guide: https://open-door.replit.app/judges

Public source: github.com/jdinovitser/Open-Door · MIT license

> **Getting started:** No account is required to explore. Choose the shared Demo connection to try Qloo-powered discovery, or connect your own Qloo account. Sign in only if you want account-backed saves across devices.

Your interests. Your circumstances.
Your kind of day.
Open Door—open up what's possible.

Five minutes.
A real cultural thread.

Start as a guest. An account is optional. Live results may vary; specific artists, venues, or numbers of results are not guaranteed.

1

Give discovery a useful starting point · 1 minute

Open Discover. Choose **Demo** for the shared Qloo API connection, or **Connect your own**. Try Brooklyn, New York, with **Nina Simone / Music** and **The Grand Budapest Hotel / Film**. Select an occasion, such as a day with a friend or a solo adventure.

The shared Demo connection makes live Qloo requests. “Try prepared examples” is a separate, authored sample path.

2

Make the day fit the person · 30 seconds

Add an editable note: “I have two hours, prefer easy walking and a quiet pause, and want something creative.” Supported browsers also offer voice input; review the transcript before continuing. Named cultural interests are entered separately.

Optional Personal Style, Age-Aware, Health & Wellbeing, and Custom scenarios help frame practical needs without making assumptions about age or health.

3

Open a door, without losing your place · 1 minute

Select **Explore with Qloo**. Wait for **Live Qloo · response received**. Open a returned door to read the recommendation in place. Look at what it recommends, why it connects to your interests, and a practical first step.

Familiar, Adjacent, and Unexpected organize the returned directions where results allow. They are Open Door route labels, not Qloo confidence or distance scores.

4

Turn discovery into something useful · 45 seconds

Try **Uncover a hidden gem** and **Add to Build My Day**. Print or **Download Word document**, then save a door. Use **Explore more ideas** to continue from its entity ID. Explicit preference memory can save intention, depth, budget, and movement.

Available coordinates open the returned location; supplied websites appear when available. Planner category searches are labeled separately. Hidden gems are authored activities, not retrieved facts. Prices, access, and availability are not verified.

5

Compare two paths from one moment · 1 minute 45 seconds

Open Discovery Lab from the journey. Start one branch, then return to the same starting checkpoint and open a different strategy, such as **Take the Wild Door**. Explore both; under **Compare branches**, select their shared checkpoint and both sibling branches. Compare discoveries, histories, evidence, conditions, and your feedback.

The branches keep independent histories. Restoring a checkpoint does not erase its sibling. Reloaded live history is a stored result—not a newly executed request.

Connect. Reimagine. Challenge.

Find these three tabs alongside Solo Discovery inside **01 — Explore for yourself**. They expand personal exploration, not replace it. All reuse the existing Qloo connection and saved-door workflow.

Beyond the Core Discovery

Open Door offers additional ways to explore cultural connections, compare perspectives, and shape discovery journeys:

- **Taste Bridge** — Compare the cultural interests of two to five people to uncover shared ground, unexpected connections, and experiences to explore together.
- **What If? Explorer** — Change circumstances and planning considerations to compare alternative discovery journeys while preserving the original.
- **Discovery Debate** — Question recommendations, ask why a discovery connects to your interests, request supporting evidence, or explore alternatives.

All three experiences build on Open Door's Qloo-grounded discovery foundation.

1

Taste Bridge · find a cultural starting point together

Open Taste Bridge. Add Nina Simone / Music for one person and Spirited Away / Film for another, then choose **Find our bridge**. Review Shared Ground, The Bridge, and The Wild Card where supported. Inspect the contributing resolved interests; save or explore a result.

Supports two to five people within the existing per-request anchor limit. Names stay in browser-session memory. Group-conditioned retrieval does not prove pairwise affinity or universal preference.

2

What If? Explorer · change the day, keep the original

Open What If? Explorer with a current discovery, saved item, or new interests. Describe a change, review recognized conditions, and edit the controls. Try a different depth or city. Compare original and alternative results, repeat, or return to the original.

Explicit rules interpret supported scenario phrases. Practical time, budget, and movement needs are local planning context, not verified Qloo suitability filters. Original preferences are preserved; unchanged results are not described as new matches.

3

Discovery Debate · ask for evidence, then alternatives

Open Discovery Debate. Select a recommendation or generate one. Ask what evidence supports it, challenge the connection, then request a more unexpected alternative. Follow up, select a returned candidate, save it, or continue exploring.

A disclosed rule-based conversation—not unrestricted AI chat. Evidence replies reference actual results and available metadata. Alternatives use Qloo, selected entity IDs, feedback, and exclusions; uncertainty stays visible.

What to inspect

All three reuse shared Demo or your connected personal key. Failed or incomplete requests remain explicit; prepared examples are never silently substituted. Session drafts and conversations are not account profiles.

The established animated mascot artwork accompanies introduction, discovery, and waiting states. Existing reduced-motion preferences show stills. No separate recommendation service or external language model was introduced.

Qloo grounds discovery. Open Door makes it usable.

Explicit interests

Named artists, films, books, or other supported cultural anchors.

Qloo Search + Insights

Resolve interests to entities. Retrieve cultural connections.

Explore & continue

Open a door, inspect evidence, follow its entity, branch, compare, and plan.

What to inspect	What it demonstrates
Successful response	Confirm the completed live response—not merely a configured connection. Shared and personal Qloo connections use the same discovery workflow.
Evidence on demand	Open **Under the Door** / source details. Cultural graph and live request trace stay collapsed until opened, keeping the main experience readable.
Entity-led continuation	A returned entity ID becomes the anchor for the next retrieval, preserving the cultural thread rather than replacing it with a generic text suggestion.
Stateful orchestration	Open Door coordinates anchor resolution, retrieval, grouping, feedback, continuations, checkpoints, and independent branch comparison. The core is structured orchestration, not an external LLM chat wrapper.
Account-backed saves	Clerk authentication and PostgreSQL-backed saved doors support cross-device access. Guest saves and Lab histories stay browser-local. Preference memory is optional and opt-in.
Practical boundaries	Sensitive free-text considerations remain browser-local. They are not sent to Qloo or stored as account preference memory. They guide local planning—not medical suitability.

What would be lost without Qloo?

The live cultural connections, resolved entity anchors, and entity-driven continuation. The welcoming interface and local planning tools remain useful, but they cannot replace the taste grounding that makes the live discovery path distinctive.

Implementation: React + TypeScript + Vite interface; Node.js + Express server; Qloo Search and Insights; Clerk authentication; PostgreSQL account storage; browser-local journey and Lab state; Word-document export. Inspect the public repository for implementation and setup.

One product.
More ways to open it.



For the person exploring

Warm, in-place results; editable personal considerations; optional browser voice input; hidden-gem activities; Maps searches; a flexible planner; print and Word export; saved doors and shareable stories.

Signed-in progress adds **Brave, Explorer, and Door Collector** tracks, medals, trophies, stars, and sharing. Rewards reflect app activity, not Qloo scores or verified real-world achievements.



For someone helping others

Use **Help others explore** in Discover or Lab. Choose an occasion or company example, edit its defaults, and create a guest link.

Try a wedding weekend or a hotel guest's afternoon. The guest keeps control of their interests and comfort. Guest links share type, public place, and occasion—not private preferences.

Optional extension · about 90 seconds

Open Partnership mockups. Start with **Destination wedding**, then select **YOUR Hotel** and **YOUR Dining**. Notice the image and featured placement change. Compare the real-estate/neighborhood and hotel/venue examples, then visit Business Model and Partnerships or Talk to us.

Commercial direction: keep individual exploration free; explore company-funded experiences, clearly labeled sponsorships, and referral partnerships. The contact form collects customization inquiries for admin review.

Preview, not a claim of traction: YOUR businesses are fictional sponsored-placement mockups. Paid advertising, referral attribution, booking integrations, external company API/MCP access, and paying partner contracts are not live. Sponsorship is not evidence of cultural fit or a Qloo endorsement.

> Real cultural grounding.
> Practical choices. A welcoming experience.

Review note: live requests require a working Qloo connection. Confirm a completed response when inspecting live results. Voice availability depends on browser support and microphone permission.

FEATURE DEEP DIVE / 1

Discovery Lab

Explore different directions without losing the path you started on. Checkpoints preserve a starting moment, independent branches let you try different approaches, and side-by-side comparison helps you choose which discovery to continue.



Recorded app view: independent branch histories and observable differences after a shared checkpoint.

Try it yourself

Choose Explore in Discovery Lab from a journey, or start in the Lab with named interests and your selected Qloo connection. Open Follow the Thread to create the starting checkpoint, open a door, and mark a result Keep. Restore that checkpoint and try Take the Wild Door. Under Compare branches, select the shared checkpoint and both sibling branches.

What judges should look for

Compare each branch's discoveries, explanations, source information, conditions, and feedback from the same starting point. Favorite and resume the path you prefer. Restore a checkpoint without erasing the sibling branch; reload to see completed exploration restored.

Qloo's role and evidence boundaries

Live branches use the selected shared Demo or personal Qloo connection through the shared discovery provider. Branch strategies influence retrieval direction, not a measured novelty score or guaranteed different results. Lab histories and checkpoints remain browser-local, including for signed-in users. Restored results are saved history, not new requests; prepared examples are a separate authored mode.

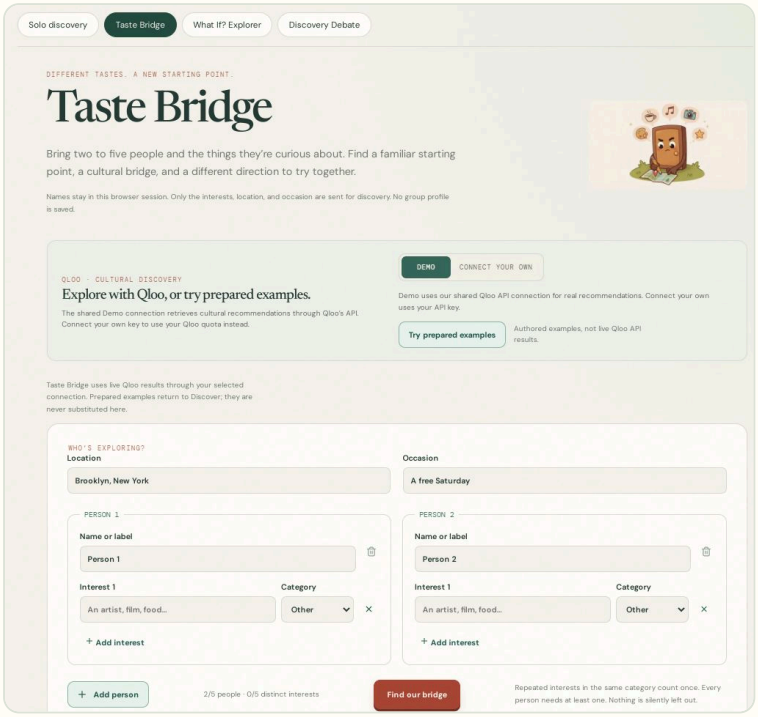
Open Discovery Lab

Uses the shared Demo connection or your connected Qloo key. Failed requests are shown explicitly, not replaced with invented recommendations. Saving and continuing a discovery reuse the existing Open Door workflow.

FEATURE DEEP DIVE / 2

Taste Bridge

Turn different interests into a shared starting point. Two to five people can contribute named artists, films, books, or other supported interests without needing the same taste.



Main page: shared or personal Qloo connection, participant interests, and Find our bridge.

Try it yourself

Add Nina Simone / Music and Spirited Away / Film for two people. Choose Find our bridge. Inspect Shared Ground, The Bridge, and The Wild Card, then save a discovery or explore it further.

What judges should look for

Participant attribution connects the submitted interests to their resolved Qloo entities. The three result roles offer different ways into the returned discoveries; a role can be absent if the evidence does not support it.

Qloo's role and evidence boundaries

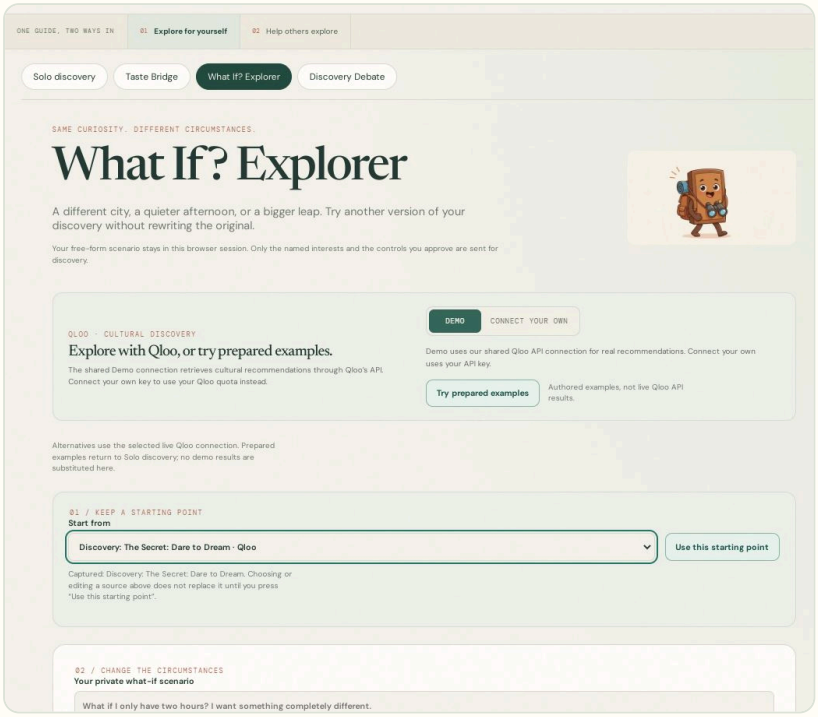
Qloo Search resolves the named interests and Insights retrieves using their combined anchors. This is group-conditioned retrieval—not proof that each participant likes every result. Names stay in browser-session memory.

Open Taste Bridge

Uses the shared Demo connection or your connected Qloo key. Failed requests are shown explicitly, not replaced with invented recommendations. Saving and continuing a discovery reuse the existing Open Door workflow.

What If? Explorer

Try a different version of your day without losing the original. Start from a current journey, a saved door, or new named interests, and compare alternatives beside an unchanged starting snapshot.



Main page: choose a starting discovery, preserve it, and describe changed circumstances.

Try it yourself

Choose Use this starting point. Enter “I only have two hours. I want something completely different.” Review and apply recognized changes, edit the controls if needed, then choose Explore this what-if.

What judges should look for

The result explains what actually changed. Compare original and alternative discoveries; change the scenario again, save a result, or restore the original scenario. An unchanged result is shown honestly rather than called a new match.

Qloo’s role and evidence boundaries

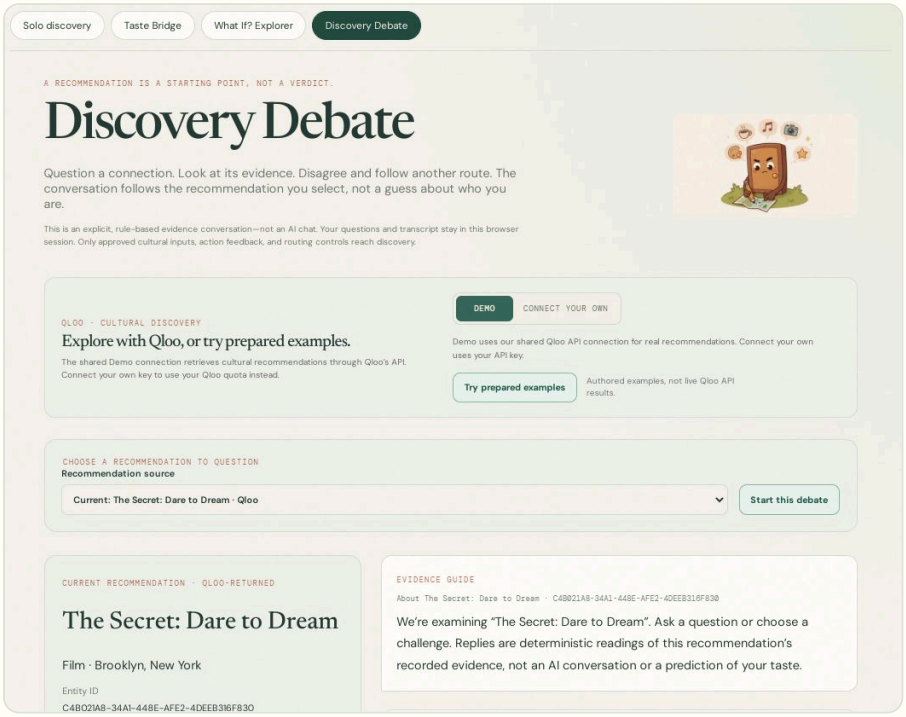
Supported phrases map to editable controls through disclosed rules. Cultural routing changes trigger Qloo retrieval; time, budget, and movement are local planning context, not verified availability, price, health, or accessibility filters.

Open What If? Explorer

Uses the shared Demo connection or your connected Qloo key. Failed requests are shown explicitly, not replaced with invented recommendations. Saving and continuing a discovery reuse the existing Open Door workflow.

Discovery Debate

Question a recommendation instead of accepting a black-box answer. Ask for its evidence, disagree with the direction, or request a more unexpected alternative, then continue the conversation about a returned discovery.



Main page: choose a recommendation to question and start an evidence-based debate.

Try it yourself

Select a current or saved recommendation, or generate one. Ask what evidence supports it and send the challenge. Next choose Retrieve something more unexpected and send it. Select a returned candidate to debate, save, or explore.

What judges should look for

The interpretation preview explains the action before submission. Transcript turns identify the recommendation being discussed. Evidence-only replies and new retrievals are visibly different, so judges can follow what actually happened.

Qloo's role and evidence boundaries

Evidence replies read recorded result metadata locally. Alternative requests use Qloo with the selected entity, supported feedback, and seen-entity exclusions. Unsupported wording asks for an explicit action; this is a rule-based evidence conversation, not unrestricted AI chat.

Open Discovery Debate

Uses the shared Demo connection or your connected Qloo key. Failed requests are shown explicitly, not replaced with invented recommendations. Saving and continuing a discovery reuse the existing Open Door workflow.